

Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

Visiting Assistant Professor
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

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Last updated: May 2025

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Romance Languages

August 2017 – August 2024

The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

- **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*
- **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

M.A. in Romance Languages

August 2015 – May 2017

The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

B.A. in Spanish

August 2010 – December 2013

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Birmingham, AL

B.S. in Biology

August 2010 – December 2013

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Birmingham, AL

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research investigates the intersection of language, identity, and social meaning, examining how speakers use phonetic variation to construct and negotiate diverse social identities. Working within the theoretical frameworks of sociophonetics and third-wave sociolinguistics, I employ performance-based methodologies that emphasize social personae to understand how linguistic choices shape social identities, with research interests spanning sexuality and gender studies, second language acquisition, and innovative pedagogical approaches in Spanish-speaking contexts.

Areas of specialization: Hispanic linguistics; phonetics and phonology; sociolinguistics; language variation and change; dialectology; quantitative/experimental methodology; language, gender, and sexuality; second language acquisition; educational technology

EMPLOYMENT

Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

Atlanta, GA

Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts in Preparation

Kelley, C. H. (in prep). Stylistic personae and syllable-final /s/ variation in Sevillian Spanish: Exploring the phonetic features of gay-sounding speech. To be submitted to *Proceedings of the Linguistics Conference at UGA 2024*.

Kelley, C. H. (in prep). Sexual orientation and sociophonetic variability in Sevillian Spanish: Toward a focus on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. To be submitted to the *Journal of Language and Sexuality*.

Research Projects in Development

A suprasegmental phonetic analysis of sexual orientation groups in Peninsular Spanish

Speech perception of sexual orientation groups in Sevillian Spanish using a matched guise methodology

PRESENTATIONS

Guest Lectures

Fall 2020. *Phonetics and Phonology Workshop*. Invited Guest Lecture: SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language course, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Conference Presentations

Kelley, C. H. (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV) 51: Queens College, Flushing, NY.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2: Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHiLL) 27: The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC): The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2020). Sounding gay and straight in Granada, Spain: Sociophonetic evidence from production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*: California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA. (Postponed due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between 'muy' and 'mucho' in Spanish. 10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics: Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA. (Canceled due to COVID-19).

Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). 'To be' or 'To not be': Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. 8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference: National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). The Madre Maria de San José (1656-1719) Project. Digitorium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3: University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Poster Presentations

Kelley, C. H. (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. 10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10): University of Georgia, Athens, GA. (Virtual).

Kelley, C. H. (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. Quantitative Methods in Linguistics course research showcase: The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

Research support award	2024
\$675, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	
Conference funding award	2023
\$500, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	
Research support award	2023
\$450, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	
Conference funding award	2023
\$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	
Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded)	2023
\$5,000, American Philosophical Society	
Research support award	2022
\$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	

Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research (not funded) \$5,000, American Philosophical Society	2022
Research support award \$300, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2021
Conference funding award \$600, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2020
Conference funding award \$762, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2020
Travel Grant \$350, UA Capstone International	2017
Conference funding award \$800, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics	2017
Graduate Teaching Assistantship UA Modern Languages and Classics	2015 – 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Emory University

SPAN 101: Introductory Spanish I Visiting Assistant Professor, 2 sections	2024 – present
SPAN 102: Introductory Spanish II Visiting Assistant Professor, 2 sections	
SPAN 201: Intermediate Spanish I Visiting Assistant Professor, 2 sections	
SPAN 212: Introduction to Hispanic Texts and Contexts Visiting Assistant Professor, 2 sections	

At The University of Alabama

SP 101: Introductory Spanish I Graduate Instructor of Record, 4 sections	2015 – 2024
SP 101: Introductory Spanish I (Online) Graduate Instructor of Record, 2 sections	
SP 102: Introductory Spanish II Graduate Instructor of Record, 5 sections	
SP 102: Introductory Spanish II (Online) Graduate Instructor of Record, 3 sections	

SP 103: Intensive Review Spanish

Graduate Instructor of Record, 1 section

SP 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Graduate Instructor of Record, 14 sections

SP 202: Intermediate Spanish II

Graduate Instructor of Record, 1 section

SP 353: Spanish Conversation

Graduate Instructor of Record, 2 sections

SP 356: Advanced Grammar and Composition

Graduate Instructor of Record, 1 section

SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language

Mentored Teaching Assistant to Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz, 1 section

At University of Montevallo**SPN 101: Introductory Spanish I**

Adjunct Instructor, 2 sections

2021 – 2022

SPN 102: Introductory Spanish II

Adjunct Instructor, 2 sections

SPN 201: Intermediate Spanish I

Adjunct Instructor, 1 section

EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY EXPERIENCE

- Incorporated online language learning platforms such as VHL Central and LingroLearning into the curriculum, enhancing interactive learning experiences and supporting diverse learning styles through multimedia content.
- Designed and launched fully online Spanish courses utilizing video lectures, interactive quizzes, and real-time discussion forums to create comprehensive virtual learning environments.
- Implemented technology-driven assessment tools within online learning platforms to track student progress and adapt instructional strategies, improving learning outcomes and engagement.
- Provided ongoing training and technical support to students and faculty on effective use of EdTech tools, ensuring smooth integration and maximizing educational benefits.
- Utilized analytics features in educational applications to monitor student engagement and performance, enabling timely interventions and personalized feedback.
- Collaborated with EdTech vendors (e.g., Vista Higher Learning) to tailor language learning software to specific curricular needs, ensuring technology solutions aligned with educational goals.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Service and Outreach

Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL) Member	2023 – present
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) Committee Member	2021 – 2022
Graduate Student Representative Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA	2021 – 2022
LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director UA (Linguistics research group)	2020 – 2021
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) IT Committee member	2020 – 2021
Spanish 102 Coordinator Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)	2020 – 2022
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) Registration Chair	2018 – 2019
Vice President, La Última Letra UA	2018 – 2019
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) Program Committee member	2017 – 2018
LengUA Lab Member	2016 – 2024
Online Teaching Certification UA	2016 – 2024
Secretary, La Última Letra UA	2016 – 2017
Vice President/Program Chair, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC) UA	2017 – 2018
Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama Event Judge	2015 – 2020

Development

Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

Writing for Academic Publication, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

Spanish Language Immersion Program, Middlebury Language Schools, Middlebury, VT. Summer 2014.

Study Abroad in Jaén, Spain, University of Alabama at Birmingham and Universidad de Jaén. Summer 2011.

Peer Review

Abstract reviewer, University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

Professional Memberships

Member, Linguistics Society of America (LSA)

Member, Acoustical Society of America (ASA)

Member, Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA)

Member, Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter), National Collegiate Hispanic Honor Society

Languages

English (native)

Spanish (near-native proficiency)

French (intermediate proficiency)

Italian (intermediate proficiency)

Additional Skills & Interests

** indicates recent use/experience*

Programming languages: R*, Python*, HTML/CSS*, $\text{\LaTeX}$ *, Bash/Unix*, PRAAT*

Operating systems: macOS Monterey*, Windows 10

Software: Microsoft Office 365*, Adobe Creative Suite*, Qualtrics*, RStudio*, SPSS, PRAAT*, Audacity, Montreal Forced Aligner*, ELAN, Zotero*, EndNote

LMS & cloud services: Blackboard*, Canvas*, Box*, Google Drive*, OneDrive*, iCloud*

Mentoring

Jordyn Battistelli

Fall 2019

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

Katie Cauley

Fall 2020

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

References

Dr. Erin O'Rourke, Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics, The University of Alabama, eorourke@ua.edu

Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz, Associate Professor of Spanish Linguistics, The University of Alabama, bjkoronkiewicz@ua.edu

Dr. Laura Rubio, Assistant Professor of Spanish Linguistics, The University of Alabama, lrubio@ua.edu